THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** treats a comic event in the style of a heroic tale	Comic epic style.
2	**(b)** affectionate	Warm.
3	**(b)** a relative clause	Defining.
4	**(b)** they may be the ones we least expect	Message.
5	**(b)** introduction of characters, conflict, climax and ironic resolution	Narrative arc.
6	**(d)** the quiet person who acts when needed	Hidden courage.
7	**(b)** false show of courage	Boasting.
8	**(d)** the hero is named a coward still	Unchanged label.
9	**(c)** playful and affectionately mocking	Tone.
10	**(a)** the contrast between looks and character	Core.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It describes a small domestic event with epic-style comparisons (1) and a dragon battle, which creates comedy (1).	1+1
12	It keeps him human (1) and reinforces the message that bravery coexists with fear (1).	1+1
13	It is amused and warm (1) so we laugh with, not at, Custard (1).	1+1
14	It creates circular closure (1) and shows nothing has changed except our view of Custard (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Looks versus nature (1). Boast versus deed (1). Hero versus label (1).	1+1+1
16	Do not judge by words (1). Courage is action (1). Humility matters (1).	1+1+1
17	Belinda said, 'The pirate has come.' (1). Quotation marks (1). Tense changes (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Invented words (1). Absurd comparisons (1). A moral beneath the nonsense (1).	1+1+1
18	Characters as puppets (1). Comic voices (1). Pirate scene with props (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Custard not only saved them but also stayed humble (1). However, he still wanted a cage (1). Unless Custard acted, the pirate would win (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Humour (1). Serious point on courage (1). Irony (1). Ending (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Definition (1). Elements (1). Examples (1). Effect (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Names (1). Hyperbole (1). Rhyme (1). Irony (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Greeting (1). Story (1). Feelings (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling the poem a tragedy; it is a **humorous ballad** by Ogden Nash that tells a story with strong rhythm and rhyme.
- Mixing the pets: Belinda's pets are **Ink** (kitten), **Blink** (mouse), **Mustard** (dog) and **Custard** (dragon).
- Saying Custard was brave in the beginning; he is the **cowardly dragon** who cries for a safe cage, but he gobbles up the pirate.
- Missing the irony: the only 'cowardly' pet is the one who **defeats the pirate**, while the others only boast about courage.
- Ignoring the devices: *simile* ('clashed his tail like iron in a dungeon'), exaggeration and comic rhymes ('realio, trulio').
- Spelling slips: *Belinda, Custard, dragon, pirate, ballad, Ogden Nash*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** a galloping, bouncy rhythm	Light rhythm.
2	**(a)** amused omniscience	Narrator.
3	**(d)** comic, not moralistic	Light.
4	**(d)** neologism for comic emphasis	Playful.
5	**(c)** dragon and pirate stories	Tropes.
6	**(c)** end-rhymes and internal echoes	Sound play.
7	**(c)** empty bravado	Boasting.
8	**(a)** oral quality	Read aloud.
9	**(d)** Characters are types, not deep portraits	Type characters.
10	**(a)** courage is revealed by action when it matters	Moral.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Others call Custard a coward (1) though he is the hero, showing reputation can be wrong (1).	1+1
12	Strong rhythm and rhyme (1) and comic words work well in performance (1).	1+1
13	Ink, Blink, Mustard, Custard suggest childlike, domestic sounds (1) that fit the playful, unthreatening world (1).	1+1
14	The pirate is fierce and aggressive (1) whereas Custard is timid yet effective (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Dragons are fierce (1). Here a dragon is timid (1). A pirate is defeated by the least expected (1).	1+1+1
16	Barrel of bears (1). Lions down the stairs (1). Pirate's arsenal (1).	1+1+1
17	courageous, valiant, fearless (1). Custard was valiant when needed (1). Each word has a shade (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Rhyme (1). Repetition of names (1). A song-like quality (1).	1+1+1
18	Little house and pets (1). Pirate invades (1). Safe world tested (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Hyperbole (1). Irony (1). They create laughter and meaning (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Intro (1). Custard (1). Other lesson (1). Comparison (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Looks vs nature (1). Claims vs deeds (1). Small vs large (1). Effect (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Custard's fear (1). Seagull's fear (1). How each acts (1). Outcome (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Custard's fear (1). His deed (1). Message (1). Reader's view (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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- Missing the irony: the only 'cowardly' pet is the one who **defeats the pirate**, while the others only boast about courage.
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- Spelling slips: *Belinda, Custard, dragon, pirate, ballad, Ogden Nash*.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** brave as a barrel full of bears	Hyperbole.
2	**(a)** circular closure	Circular.
3	**(a)** the fierce dragon	Dragon stereotype.
4	**(c)** childlike simplicity and comic understatement	Tone.
5	**(b)** showing Custard's deed	Show don't tell.
6	**(d)** emphasise cosiness and smallness	Domestic.
7	**(a)** Never had the pets been so scared.	Inversion after 'never'.
8	**(b)** humour and a simple moral are universal	Universal.
9	**(a)** comic simplicity	Type character.
10	**(c)** had not fought	Third conditional.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The language is silly (1) but the theme of true courage is meaningful (1).	1+1
12	A little house and tiny pets (1) meet a large dragon and a pirate, creating comic disproportion (1).	1+1
13	They are instantly recognisable (1) allowing quick comedy and a clear moral (1).	1+1
14	The hidden strength of the gentle (1) or the misjudged individual (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Custard is labelled coward (1). He proves otherwise (1). The label sticks in the end, hinting at prejudice (1).	1+1+1
16	Tinky was a tiger, striped and tall (1). He hid when anyone came to call (1). When a burglar crept inside one night (1). He roared so loud it gave him a fright (1).	1+1+1
17	Rhythm (1). Humour (1). Different voices (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Custard: timid but brave (1). Valli: young but bold (1). Both challenge expectations (1).	1+1+1
18	The pirate was gobbled up by Custard (1). Past passive (1). Meaning retained (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It deals with courage (1). It uses irony (1). It comments on labels (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Roles (1). Voice (1). Actions (1). Props (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Poem (1). Arguments (1). Counterpoint (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Title (1). Rhyme (1). Story (1). Humour (1). Ending (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Rhythm (1). Rhyme (1). Meaning (1). Mood (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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